

Diagnosis	
Laboratory Findings	
Test	Finding
Creatine kinase (CK)	↑ markedly
Lactate dehydrogenase	↑
Aspartate aminotransferase (AST)/ALT	↑ (muscle source)
Antinuclear antibody (ANA)	↑
Anti-Jo-1	Often positive
Autoantibodies	
Antibody	Association
Anti-Jo-1	Polymyositis
Anti-Mi-2	Dermatomyositis
Anti-SRP	Severe polymyositis
Anti-Jo-1 also associated with interstitial lung disease .	
EMG Findings	
Electromyography shows:	
Myopathic pattern	
Short-duration, low-amplitude motor potentials.	
Muscle Biopsy (Gold Standard)	
Disease	Histology
Polymyositis	Endomysial inflammation + CD8 T cells
Dermatomyositis	Perivascular inflammation + perifascicular atrophy

This micrograph shows a section of skeletal muscle tissue stained with hematoxylin and eosin (H&E). The muscle fibers are large and pink. A prominent feature is a dense, dark-staining infiltrate of inflammatory cells, primarily lymphocytes, which is located within the muscle tissue, particularly around and between the muscle fibers. This pattern of inflammation is characteristic of polymyositis.

Symptoms

- Difficulty **climbing stairs**
- Difficulty **lifting arms**
- Difficulty **standing from chair**
- Difficulty **combing hair**

Important:

- **Weakness > pain**

cracked skin
on finger-tips)

